

CHAPTER 2

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom

NCERT Exercise Solutions

- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Before You Read — 3 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Oral Comprehension Check (Page 18–19) — 5 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Oral Comprehension Check (Page 21) — 5 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Oral Comprehension Check (Page 24) — 3 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Thinking about the Text — 5 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Thinking about Language — 10 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Speaking — 1 Q
- Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Writing — 5 Q
- A Tiger in the Zoo · Before You Read — 1 Q

✨ Try each question yourself first, then check the answer. 💡
answers are samples: write your own.

Independent study aid by Beginers Point. Not an official NCERT publication.

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Before You Read

1 **'Apartheid' is a political system that separates people according to their race. Can you say which of the three countries named below had such a political system until very recently? (i) United States of America (ii) South Africa (iii) Australia**

✔ ANSWER

(ii) South Africa. It followed apartheid until the early 1990s; in 1994 its first democratic elections were held and Mandela became the first black President.

2 **Mandela speaks about a historic occasion, 'the inauguration'. Can you guess what the occasion might be?**

✔ ANSWER

It is the **swearing-in ceremony of Nelson Mandela as South Africa's first black President** on 10 May 1994, in the Union Buildings amphitheatre, Pretoria.

Activity **Match each expression in Column A with an appropriate meaning from Column B.**

(i) A rainbow gathering of different colours and nations

(ii) The seat of white supremacy

(iii) Be overwhelmed with a sense of history

(iv) Resilience that defies the imagination

(v) A glimmer of humanity

(vi) A twilight existence

✔ ANSWER

(i) A rainbow gathering of different colours and nations – **a beautiful coming together of various peoples, like the colours in a rainbow**

(ii) The seat of white supremacy – **the centre of racial superiority**

(iii) Be overwhelmed with a sense of history – **feel deeply emotional, remembering and understanding all the past events that have led up to the moment**

(iv) Resilience that defies the imagination – **a great ability (almost unimaginable) to remain unchanged by suffering (not losing hope, goodness or courage)**

(v) A glimmer of humanity – **a sign of human feeling (goodness, kindness, pity, justice, etc.)**

(vi) A twilight existence – **a half-secret life, like a life lived in the fading light between sunset and darkness**

Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Oral Comprehension Check (Page 18–19)

1 **Where did the ceremonies take place? Can you name any public buildings in India that are made of sandstone?**

✔ ANSWER

The ceremonies took place in the lovely **sandstone amphitheatre formed by the Union Buildings in Pretoria**.

Sandstone buildings in India: **Rashtrapati Bhavan, Parliament House, the Red Fort (Delhi), Fatehpur Sikri and Hawa Mahal (Jaipur)**.

2 **Can you say how 10 May is an 'autumn day' in South Africa?**

✔ ANSWER

South Africa lies in the **Southern Hemisphere**, where the seasons are opposite to ours. So May, which is summer in India, falls in **autumn** there.

3 **At the beginning of his speech, Mandela mentions "an extraordinary human disaster". What does he mean by this? What is the "glorious … human achievement" he speaks of at the end?**

✔ ANSWER

By “an extraordinary human disaster” Mandela means **apartheid**, the long rule of racial discrimination in which black people were oppressed by the whites.

The “glorious human achievement” is the **end of apartheid and the setting up of South Africa’s first democratic, non-racial government**, with a black President elected freely and fairly.

4 **What does Mandela thank the international leaders for?**

✔ ANSWER

He thanks them for **coming to South Africa to take possession, with its people, of a common victory for justice, for peace and for human dignity**. Earlier these nations had broken off relations with South Africa because of apartheid.

5 **What ideals does he set out for the future of South Africa?**

✔ ANSWER

Mandela pledges to:

- **liberate all people** from the continuing bondage of poverty, deprivation, suffering, gender and other discrimination;

- ensure that this beautiful land **never again experiences the oppression of one by another**;
- let **freedom reign** and build a society of which all humanity will be proud.

⭐ Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Oral Comprehension Check (Page 21)

1 **What do the military generals do? How has their attitude changed, and why?**

✔ ANSWER

The highest generals of the defence force and police, their chests bedecked with ribbons and medals, **saluted Mandela and pledged their loyalty** to him.

Earlier they **would have arrested him** (he was a 'criminal' fighting apartheid). Their attitude changed because **apartheid had ended** and Mandela was now the freely and fairly elected President; they were loyal to democracy.

2 **Why were two national anthems sung?**

✔ ANSWER

Two anthems were sung – 'Nkosi Sikelel– iAfrika' (sung by whites) and 'Die Stem', the old anthem (sung by blacks). This showed **equal respect for both blacks and whites** and the **unity of all races** in the new South Africa.

3 **How does Mandela describe the systems of government in his country (i) in the first decade, and (ii) in the final decade, of the twentieth century?**

✔ ANSWER

(i) **First decade:** the white-skinned peoples patched up their differences and set up a **system of racial domination** against the dark-skinned peoples – one of the harshest, most inhumane societies the world has known.

(ii) **Final decade:** that system had been **overturned forever** and replaced by one that **recognised the rights and freedoms of all peoples, regardless of the colour of their skin**.

4 **What does courage mean to Mandela?**

✔ ANSWER

To Mandela, **courage is not the absence of fear but the triumph over it**. "The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear."

5 **Which does he think is natural, to love or to hate?**

✔ ANSWER

He thinks **love is more natural**. No one is born hating others; people learn to hate, so they can also be taught to love, "for love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite".

⭐ Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Oral Comprehension Check (Page 24)

1 **What "twin obligations" does Mandela mention?**

✔ ANSWER

Every man has two obligations: **to his family** – his parents, wife and children; and **to his people, his community and his country**.

2 **What did being free mean to Mandela as a boy, and as a student? How does he contrast these "transitory freedoms" with "the basic and honourable freedoms"?**

✔ ANSWER

- **As a boy:** freedom meant running in the fields near his mother's hut, swimming in the village stream, roasting mealies under the stars and riding the backs of slow-moving bulls.
- **As a student:** freedom meant staying out at night, reading what he pleased and going where he chose. These were **"transitory"** (temporary) freedoms, only for himself.

- **As a young man in Johannesburg** he wanted the **basic and honourable freedoms** – achieving his potential, earning his keep, marrying and having a family, not being obstructed in a lawful life. These are lasting, essential freedoms that give a life dignity.

3 **Does Mandela think the oppressor is free? Why/Why not?**

✔ ANSWER

No. A man who takes away another man's freedom is **"a prisoner of hatred"**, locked behind the bars of prejudice and narrow-mindedness. Both the oppressed and the oppressor are robbed of their humanity, so the oppressor too must be liberated.

🤔 Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Thinking about the Text

1 **Why did such a large number of international leaders attend the inauguration? What did it signify the triumph of?**

✔ ANSWER

Leaders from more than 140 countries came to **show their solidarity** with the people of South Africa and to welcome its **first democratic, non-racial government**. Many of these countries had earlier broken off relations with South Africa because of apartheid.

It signified the **triumph of justice, peace and human dignity** – a victory of good over evil and of democracy over racial discrimination.

2 **What does Mandela mean when he says he is "simply the sum of all those African patriots" who had gone before him?**

✔ ANSWER

Mandela means that **he alone did not win freedom**. He was the result of the sacrifices of thousands of patriots like Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu and Chief Luthuli who fought apartheid before him. Their long and noble line ended and began again with him; he was only carrying their struggle forward, and he was pained that they could not see what their sacrifices had achieved.

3 **Would you agree that the "depths of oppression" create "heights of character"? How does Mandela illustrate this? Can you add your own examples to this argument?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Yes, I agree. Great suffering brings out courage, wisdom and generosity in people.

Mandela says the decades of oppression in South Africa produced men like **Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu, Chief Luthuli, Yusuf Dadoo, Bram Fischer and Robert Sobukwe** – men of such extraordinary courage, wisdom and generosity that their like may never be known again.

Examples from India: British rule produced leaders like **Mahatma Gandhi, Bhagat Singh, Subhas Chandra Bose, Sardar Patel and Dr B. R. Ambedkar**, who faced oppression and discrimination with great strength of character.

4 **How did Mandela's understanding of freedom change with age and experience?**

✔ ANSWER

- **As a boy** he thought he was born free – free to run, swim, roast mealies and ride bulls, as long as he obeyed his father and the customs of his tribe.
- **As a student** he wanted transitory freedoms for himself – to stay out at night, read what he liked and go where he chose.
- **As a young man in Johannesburg** he wanted basic, honourable freedoms – to achieve his potential, earn his keep and have a family.

- Finally he saw that **his people were not free**. His hunger for his own freedom became **the greater hunger for the freedom of his people**. He understood that freedom is indivisible and that even the oppressor must be liberated.

5 **How did Mandela's 'hunger for freedom' change his life?**

✔ ANSWER

His desire for the freedom of his people, to live with dignity and self-respect, **transformed his whole life**:

- it turned a **frightened young man into a bold one**;
- it drove a **law-abiding attorney to become a criminal**;
- it turned a **family-loving husband into a man without a home**;
- it forced a **life-loving man to live like a monk**.

He joined the African National Congress, lived a secret life of rebellion and spent about thirty years in prison, and could not fulfil his duties as a son, brother, father and husband.

🤔 Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Thinking about Language

I.1 There are nouns in the text (formation, government) which are formed from the corresponding verbs (form, govern) by suffixing -(at)ion or -ment. Make a list of such pairs of nouns and verbs in the text.

✔ ANSWER

Noun	Verb
rebellion	rebel
constitution	constitute
formation	form
government	govern
inauguration	inaugurate
installation	install
demonstration	demonstrate
emancipation	emancipate
deprivation	deprive
discrimination	discriminate
oppression	oppress
achievement	achieve
imagination	imagine
domination	dominate
obligation	oblige

I.2 Read the paragraph below. Fill in the blanks with the noun forms of the verbs in brackets.

Martin Luther King's _____ (contribute) to our history as an outstanding leader began when he came to the _____ (assist) of Rosa Parks, a seamstress who refused to give up her seat on a bus to a white passenger. In those days American Blacks were confined to positions of second class citizenship by restrictive laws and customs. To break these laws would mean _____ (subjugate) and _____ (humiliate) by the police and the legal system. Beatings, _____ (imprison) and sometimes death awaited those who defied the System. Martin Luther King's tactics of protest involved non-violent _____ (resist) to racial injustice.

✔ ANSWER

Martin Luther King's **contribution** to our history as an outstanding leader began when he came to the **assistance** of Rosa Parks, a seamstress who refused to give up her seat on a bus to a white passenger. In those days American Blacks were confined to positions of second class citizenship by restrictive laws and customs. To break these laws would mean **subjugation** and **humiliation** by the police and the legal system. Beatings, **imprisonment** and sometimes death awaited those who defied the System. Martin Luther King's tactics of protest involved non-violent **resistance** to racial injustice.

II **Using the Definite Article with Names: "... the decades of oppression and brutality ... produced the Oliver Tambos, the Walter Sisulus, ... of our time." What do the names mean? (a) for example Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu, ... (b) many other men like Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu .../many men of their type or kind, whose names may not be as well known.**

✔ ANSWER

(b) many other men like Oliver Tambo, Walter Sisulu – many men of their type or kind, whose names may not be as well known. 'The' + a plural proper noun stands for people of that kind.

II.1 **Say what this sentence means: Mr Singh regularly invites the Amitabh Bachchans and the Shah Rukh Khans to his parties.**

✔ ANSWER

Mr Singh regularly invites **famous film stars and celebrities like Amitabh Bachchan and Shah Rukh Khan** to his parties.

II.2 **Say what this sentence means: Many people think that Madhuri Dixit is the Madhubala of our times.**

✔ ANSWER

Many people think that Madhuri Dixit is **as beautiful and as great an actress as Madhubala** was in her time.

II.3 **Say what this sentence means: History is not only the story of the Alexanders, the Napoleons and the Hitlers, but of ordinary people as well.**

✔ ANSWER

History is not only the story of **great conquerors and powerful rulers like Alexander, Napoleon and Hitler**, but also of ordinary people.

III.1 **Match: "I was not unmindful of the fact" – (i) had not forgotten; was aware of the fact (ii) was not careful about the fact (iii) forgot or was not aware of the fact**

✔ ANSWER

(i) had not forgotten; was aware of the fact. Mandela was aware that the generals would earlier have arrested him.

III.2 **Match: “when my comrades and I were pushed to our limits” – (i) pushed by the guards to the wall (ii) took more than our share of beatings (iii) felt that we could not endure the suffering any longer**

✔ ANSWER

(iii) felt that we could not endure the suffering any longer. ‘Pushed to our limits’ means pushed to the last point in their ability to bear pain.

III.3 **Match: “to reassure me and keep me going” – (i) make me go on walking (ii) help me continue to live in hope in this very difficult situation (iii) make me remain without complaining**

✔ ANSWER

(ii) help me continue to live in hope in this very difficult situation. A glimmer of humanity in a guard gave him hope in prison.

III.4 **Match: “the basic and honourable freedoms of ... earning my keep, ...” – (i) earning enough money to live on (ii) keeping what I earned (iii) getting a good salary**

✔ ANSWER

(i) earning enough money to live on. 'Earning one's keep' means earning enough for food and shelter.

⭐ Nelson Mandela: Long Walk to Freedom · Speaking

1 **In groups, discuss the issues suggested in the box below. Then prepare a speech of about two minutes on the following topic. (First make notes for your speech in writing.)**

True liberty is freedom from poverty, deprivation and all forms of discrimination.

- **causes of poverty and means of overcoming it**
- **discrimination based on gender, religion, class, etc.**
- **constitutionally guaranteed human rights**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Notes:

- Political freedom alone is not enough; poor and deprived people are not truly free.
- Causes of poverty: illiteracy, unemployment, population growth, lack of skills, corruption. Remedies: education, skill training, jobs, welfare schemes.
- Discrimination by gender, caste, religion and class denies people equal chances.

- Our Constitution guarantees the Right to Equality, Right to Freedom, Right against Exploitation and Right to Education.

Speech:

Good morning, respected teachers and dear friends. Today I will speak on the topic 'True liberty is freedom from poverty, deprivation and all forms of discrimination'.

India became politically free in 1947, but is every Indian truly free? A child who works in a dhaba instead of going to school, or a family that sleeps hungry, does not enjoy real liberty. Poverty is caused by illiteracy, unemployment and lack of skills. We can overcome it through education, skill training and honest welfare schemes.

Discrimination is another chain. When a girl is not allowed to study, or a person is insulted because of caste, religion or class, freedom becomes meaningless. Our Constitution guarantees equality before the law, freedom of speech, the right against exploitation and the right to education. We must know these rights and respect them for others.

As Nelson Mandela said, the chains on any one of our people are the chains on all of us. Let us work together so that every Indian is free from poverty, deprivation and discrimination. Thank you.

I **Looking at Contrasts: Use the following phrases to complete the sentences. Phrases: (i) they can be taught to love. (ii) I was born free. (iii) but the triumph over it. (iv) but he who conquers that fear. (v) to create such heights of character. Sentences: 1. It requires such depths of oppression 2. Courage was not the absence of fear 3. The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid 4. If people can learn to hate 5. I was not born with a hunger to be free.**

✔ ANSWER

1. It requires such depths of oppression **to create such heights of character.** (v)
2. Courage was not the absence of fear **but the triumph over it.** (iii)
3. The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid **but he who conquers that fear.** (iv)
4. If people can learn to hate, **they can be taught to love.** (i)
5. I was not born with a hunger to be free. **I was born free.** (ii)

II **Find in the text the second part of the contrast, and complete each item. Identify the words which signal the contrast.**

1. For decades the Union Buildings had been the seat of white supremacy, and now ...

2. Only moments before, the highest generals of the South African defence force and police ... saluted me and pledged their loyalty. ... not so many years before they would not have saluted

3. Although that day neither group knew the lyrics of the anthem ..., they would soon

4. My country is rich in the minerals and gems that lie beneath its soil,

5. The Air Show was not only a display of pinpoint precision and military force, but

6. It was this desire for the freedom of my people ... that transformed _____ into a bold one, that drove _____ to become a criminal, that turned _____ into a man without a home.

✔ ANSWER

1. ... and now **it was the site of a rainbow gathering of different colours and nations for the installation of South Africa's first democratic, non-racial government.** (Signal: **For decades ... and now**)

2. ... not so many years before they would not have saluted **but arrested me.** (Signal: **Only moments before ... not so many years before ... but**)

3. Although that day neither group knew the lyrics of the anthem they once despised, they would soon **know the words by heart.** (Signal: **Although ... soon**)

4. My country is rich in the minerals and gems that lie beneath its soil, **but I have always known that its greatest wealth is its people, finer and truer than the purest diamonds.** (Signal: **but**)

5. The Air Show was not only a display of pinpoint precision and military force, but **a demonstration of the military's loyalty to democracy, to a new government that had been freely and fairly elected.** (Signal: **not only ... but**)

6. It was this desire for the freedom of my people ... that transformed **a frightened young man** into a bold one, that drove **a law-abiding attorney** to become a criminal, that turned **a family-loving husband** into a man without a home. (Signal: **transformed ... into, drove ... to become, turned ... into**)

III **Expressing Your Opinion: Do you think there is colour prejudice in our own country? Discuss this with your friend and write a paragraph of about 100 to 150 words about this. You have the option of making your paragraph a humorous one.**

💡 **SAMPLE ANSWER**

Colour Prejudice in India

Sadly, yes, colour prejudice still exists in our country. Many Indians believe that a fair complexion is a sign of beauty and superiority. Matrimonial advertisements ask for a ‘fair’ bride, and fairness creams are sold in huge numbers with the false promise of success. Dark-skinned children are often teased in school, and some people from the North-East or from Africa face rude remarks because of how they look. Such thinking hurts people’s self-respect and divides society. Yet colour is only a matter of skin; it says nothing about a person’s talent, character or worth. Many of our greatest leaders, artists and sportspersons are dark-skinned. As Nelson Mandela said, no one is born hating others; people learn to hate, so they can be taught to love. We must change this attitude in our homes, schools and media, and judge people only by their character and abilities.

What You Can Do

Divide your class into three groups and give each group one of the following topics to research: (i) black Americans, and their fight against discrimination, (ii) women, and their fight for equality, (iii) the Vietnamese, and their fight for independence. Choose a student from each group to present a short summary of each topic to the class.

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Points for the summaries:

- **(i) Black Americans:** slavery until 1865; segregation laws; Rosa Parks' bus protest (1955); Martin Luther King Jr's non-violent Civil Rights Movement; Civil Rights Act (1964) and Voting Rights Act (1965); Barack Obama, first black US President (2008).
- **(ii) Women:** struggle for the right to vote (suffragettes; women voted in the UK from 1918/1928, USA 1920); fight for equal education, equal pay and against dowry and violence; in India, leaders like Savitribai Phule and Sarojini Naidu; reservation for women in local bodies and the Women's Reservation Act (2023).

- **(iii) The Vietnamese:** ruled by France as a colony; Ho Chi Minh led the freedom struggle; French defeated at Dien Bien Phu (1954); long war with the USA; country reunited and independent in 1975–76.

Homophones

Can you find the words below that are spelt similarly, and sometimes even pronounced similarly, but have very different meanings? • The bandage was wound around the wound. • The soldier decided to desert his dessert in the desert.

✔ ANSWER

- **wound** /waʊnd/ – past tense of 'wind' (wrapped around); **wound** /wuːnd/ – an injury.
- **desert** /dɪˈzɜːt/ (verb) – to leave or abandon; **dessert** /dɪˈzɜːt/ – a sweet dish after a meal; **desert** /ˈdezət/ (noun) – a dry, sandy region.

⭐ A Tiger in the Zoo · Before You Read

1 **Read the poem silently once, and say which stanzas speak about the tiger in the zoo, and which ones speak about the tiger in the jungle.**

✔ ANSWER

- **Tiger in the zoo:** stanzas **1, 4 and 5**.

- **Tiger in the jungle:** stanzas **2 and 3**.

🤔 A Tiger in the Zoo · Thinking about the Poem

1(i) **Find the words that describe the movements and actions of the tiger in the cage and in the wild. Arrange them in two columns.**

✔ ANSWER

In the cage	In the wild
stalks (the few steps of his cage)	lurking in shadow
on pads of velvet quiet	sliding through long grass
in his quiet rage	snarling around houses
locked in a concrete cell	baring his white fangs, his claws
stalking the length of his cage	terrorising the village
ignoring visitors	
hears the last voice at night	
stares (with his brilliant eyes)	

1(ii) **Find the words that describe the two places, and arrange them in two columns. Now try to share ideas about how the poet uses words and images to contrast the two situations.**

✔ ANSWER

The zoo (cage)	The jungle (wild)
the few steps of his cage	shadow
concrete cell	long grass
behind bars	water hole where plump deer pass
patrolling cars	houses at the jungle's edge
	the village

Contrast: In the zoo the tiger is **confined to a small concrete cage**, angry but helpless, and ignores the visitors. In the jungle he is **free, powerful and natural** – hiding in shadows, hunting deer and frightening villagers. Words like 'locked', 'bars' and 'concrete cell' show captivity, while 'lurking', 'sliding' and 'snarling' show freedom and strength.

2 **Notice the use of a word repeated in lines such as these: (i) On pads of velvet quiet, / In his quiet rage. (ii) And stares with his brilliant eyes / At the brilliant stars. What do you think is the effect of this repetition?**

✔ ANSWER

The repetition **draws attention and creates a contrast**:

- (i) 'quiet' first describes his soft, silent footsteps, and then his **silent, helpless anger** at being caged. His rage is quiet because he can do nothing.
- (ii) 'brilliant' links his bright eyes to the bright stars. It shows his **longing for freedom** – he stares at the stars as if they are as free and far as his lost life in the wild.

It also adds rhythm and makes the images stronger.

3 **Read the following two poems — one about a tiger (The Tiger, Peter Niblett) and the other about a panther (The Panther, Rainer Maria Rilke). Then discuss: Are zoos necessary for the protection or conservation of some species of animals? Are they useful for educating the public? Are there alternatives to zoos?**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

- **Protection:** Zoos can help save **endangered species** through breeding programmes and care, when their habitats are being destroyed or they are hunted. The tiger in Niblett's poem thinks that in the wild hunters, poisoned food or water might kill him.
- **Education:** Zoos help people, especially children, **see animals closely** and learn about them and the need to protect them.
- **But:** caged animals lose their natural life. Like Rilke's panther, they become weary and their 'mighty will stands paralysed'.
- **Alternatives: national parks, wildlife sanctuaries and biosphere reserves** (e.g. Jim Corbett, Ranthambore, Project Tiger reserves), where animals live in their natural habitat and are protected by law; strict laws against poaching; documentaries and online learning.

4 **Take a point of view for or against zoos, or even consider both points of view and write a couple of paragraphs or speak about this topic for a couple of minutes in class.**

💡 SAMPLE ANSWER

Zoos: For and Against

Zoos have some clear benefits. They protect endangered animals whose forests are being cut down or who are hunted by poachers. Breeding programmes in zoos have saved several species from dying out. Zoos also teach the public, especially children, about animals and make them care for wildlife. Many people would never see a tiger or an elephant without a zoo.

On the other hand, a zoo is a prison for a wild animal. Like the tiger in Leslie Norris's poem, animals pace up and down in small cages, full of 'quiet rage', far from the forests where they should hunt freely. They lose their natural habits and often suffer from stress. In my view, wildlife sanctuaries and national parks are a better choice. There animals live in their natural homes and are still protected. Zoos should be used only to rescue, treat and breed endangered animals, not just to entertain visitors.

🎉 **Chapter 2 done! Revise the answers once more tomorrow.**